



About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. Scholars may see some variation in artworks studied and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Studio Art 1 is an apprenticeship in seeing. Scholars learn that beauty has structure: the Elements of Art and Principles of Design are the grammar, and great works from many cultures and centuries are the teachers. The course climbs the classical ladder from studied looking and copying toward original work: scholars study Japanese Notan and anime, Matisse's cut-outs, pointillism and stippling, Chuck Close's grid portraits, West African masks and Picasso, one-point perspective, color theory, and the drawn face, making real artwork at every step. VR sessions pair with the studio work, and quarterly VR gallery walks put finished pieces in front of classmates. Every finished work is signed by the artist and added to a growing portfolio.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE — 4 QUARTERS · 36 WEEKS

Quarter · Focus	What scholars study and make
Q1 · Foundations & Mark-Making	Why study art?; the Elements of Art as building blocks; Japanese art (Notan, Zentangle, anime, Matisse cut-outs); stippling and pointillism with color theory; Chuck Close fingerprint and grid portraits; Byzantine mosaics; Inktober daily drawing
Q2 · Composition & Perspective	One-point perspective and balance (with Jamie Wyeth); a magazine collage project; West African art and Picasso, leading to mask designs; rendering studies (metallic bows, foil balloon letters, snow globes); December VR gallery walk
Q3 · Color & the Face	Color theory: monochromatic painting and the color wheel; personal symbols; castle perspective drawing; the "Let's Face It!" portrait sequence — eyes, noses, mouths, full faces, faces through time in VR, and a before-and-after self-portrait; figure box drawings
Q4 · Putting It All Together	A profile portrait after Sargent's <i>Madame X</i> ; grid-overlay animal drawings; blackout poetry; collaborative VR murals ; the year-end gallery of finished work

THE TWO-WEEK CYCLE

Week	What the scholar does (~50 min/day, M–F)
Week 1 Learn & Look	A lesson page that opens with real artworks worth wondering at; a sketch assignment or warm-up practicing the technique; a VR session paired with the lesson; a short auto-graded quiz.
Week 2 Make & Reflect	The cycle's finished artwork , signed by the artist and submitted with a short artist statement . This is the one substantial graded piece of each cycle; sketches, VR sessions, and quizzes are completion or auto-scored.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes per week is the school's designated planning figure for this course: about 50 minutes a day, Monday through Friday. Looking, sketching, and the finished artwork are the core of that time. **Artwork weeks** can run longer when a piece is going well; that is part of the joy of studio work.

STUDIO HABITS THAT MATTER

- ▶ **Every finished work is signed:** this is mine, I made it, I stand behind it
- ▶ Warm-ups keep the hand moving: still lifes, scribble sketches, emotion faces, shadow studies
- ▶ **Reflections** after major pieces ask what worked, what resisted, and what to try next
- ▶ Quarterly **VR gallery walks** put scholars' work in front of classmates
- ▶ Finished pieces are photographed and kept in a tidy OneDrive folder, building a **portfolio** the scholar carries out of the course

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- ▶ Basic studio materials: sketchbook, pencils, ink pens, paper, and paint (the teacher's section confirms the supply list)
- ▶ A phone or camera to photograph finished work for submission
- ▶ **VR headset** for Optima's VR campus: paired VR sessions, gallery walks, and collaborative murals
- ▶ OneDrive (Microsoft 365) for the portfolio folder

NOTES FOR FAMILIES

On-Demand (asynchronous). This course is designed for self-paced study with due dates for pacing. A teacher is available throughout for support, feedback on artwork, and grading.

Live school. Scholars enrolled in the live school complete the same course in VR with a teacher and classmates on a regular weekly schedule.